

APARTMENT SEARCH DOSSIER

Chicago Apartment Report

Professional weekend review packet for a July 1, 2026 move focused on Lakeview, Lincoln Park, Wicker Park, and Logan Square, with address-level geocoding, shortlist screening, and commute evidence panels for the final candidates.

BUDGET

\$2,400 max

UNIT NEED

1 bed or larger

HARD FILTER

In-unit laundry

Prepared for: July 1 move search

Office destination: 233 S Wacker Dr, Chicago, IL 60606

Commute rule applied: reject any candidate with reported transit commute over 45 minutes

Pet requirement: one 45 lb dog

Important notation: route evidence images in this version are labeled evidence panels, not raw Google Maps screenshots, and are marked accordingly inside each apartment section.

Executive Summary

This report recommends four finalists that stayed inside your price ceiling and passed visible dog/laundry screening. The strongest all-around pick is still **663 W Melrose St**, while **1509 W Thomas St unit 2F** is the commute-first option. **1824 W Augusta Blvd** gives the most useful floor plan because of the den, and **Noca Blu Apartment Homes** is the cleanest professionally managed Logan Square option.

Ranked Recommendation

1. 663 W Melrose St, Chicago, IL 60657

2. 1509 W Thomas St unit 2F, Chicago, IL 60642

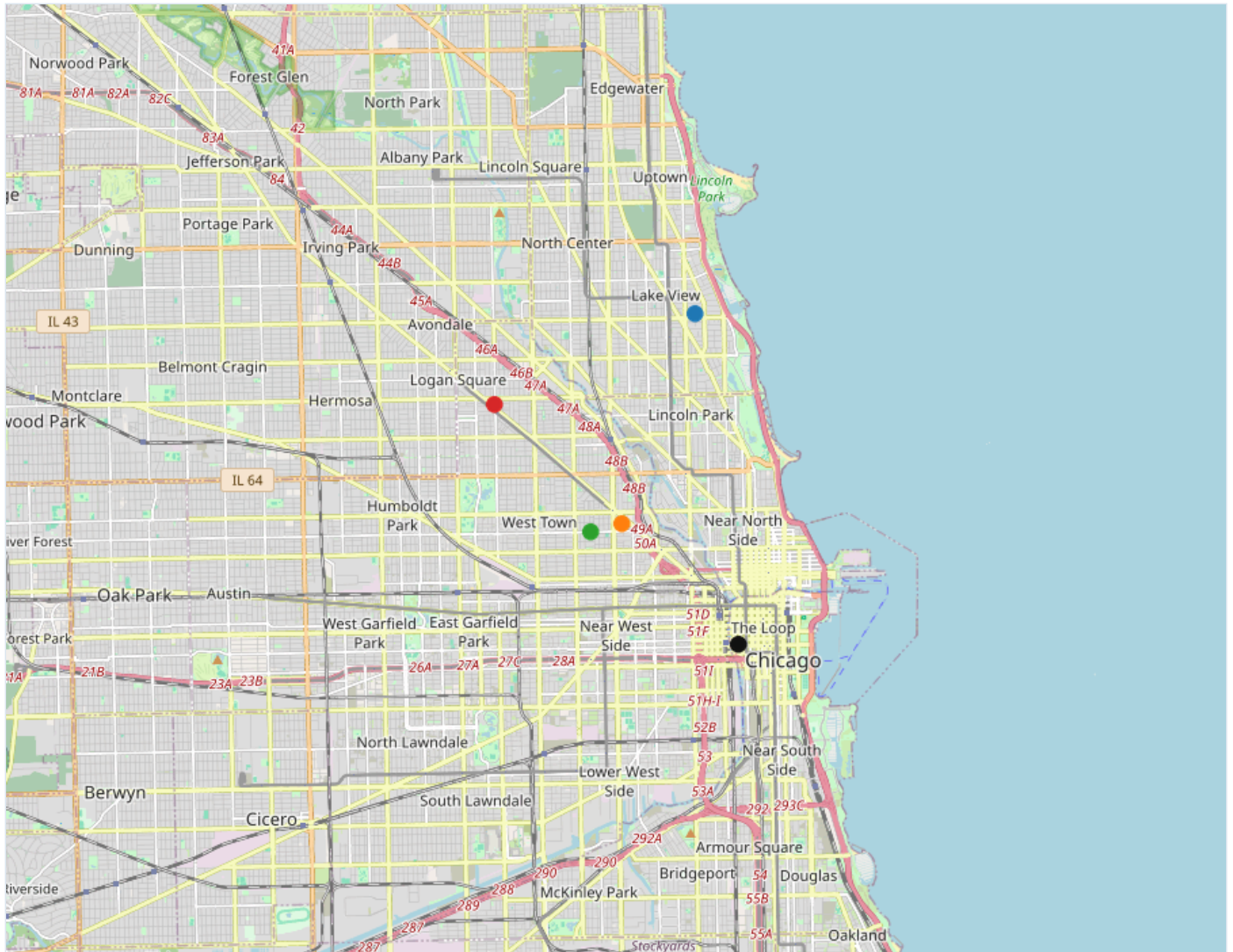
3. 1824 W Augusta Blvd, Chicago, IL 60622

4. Noca Blu Apartment Homes, 2340 N California Ave, Chicago, IL 60647

Uncertainty label used in this PDF: apartment photos are real listing images, but the route visuals are not raw transit screenshots captured from a live trip planner. They are explicitly labeled inside the apartment sections as **route evidence panels**. Commute numbers are therefore presented as reported values used for screening, with route-image limitations disclosed in place.

Map

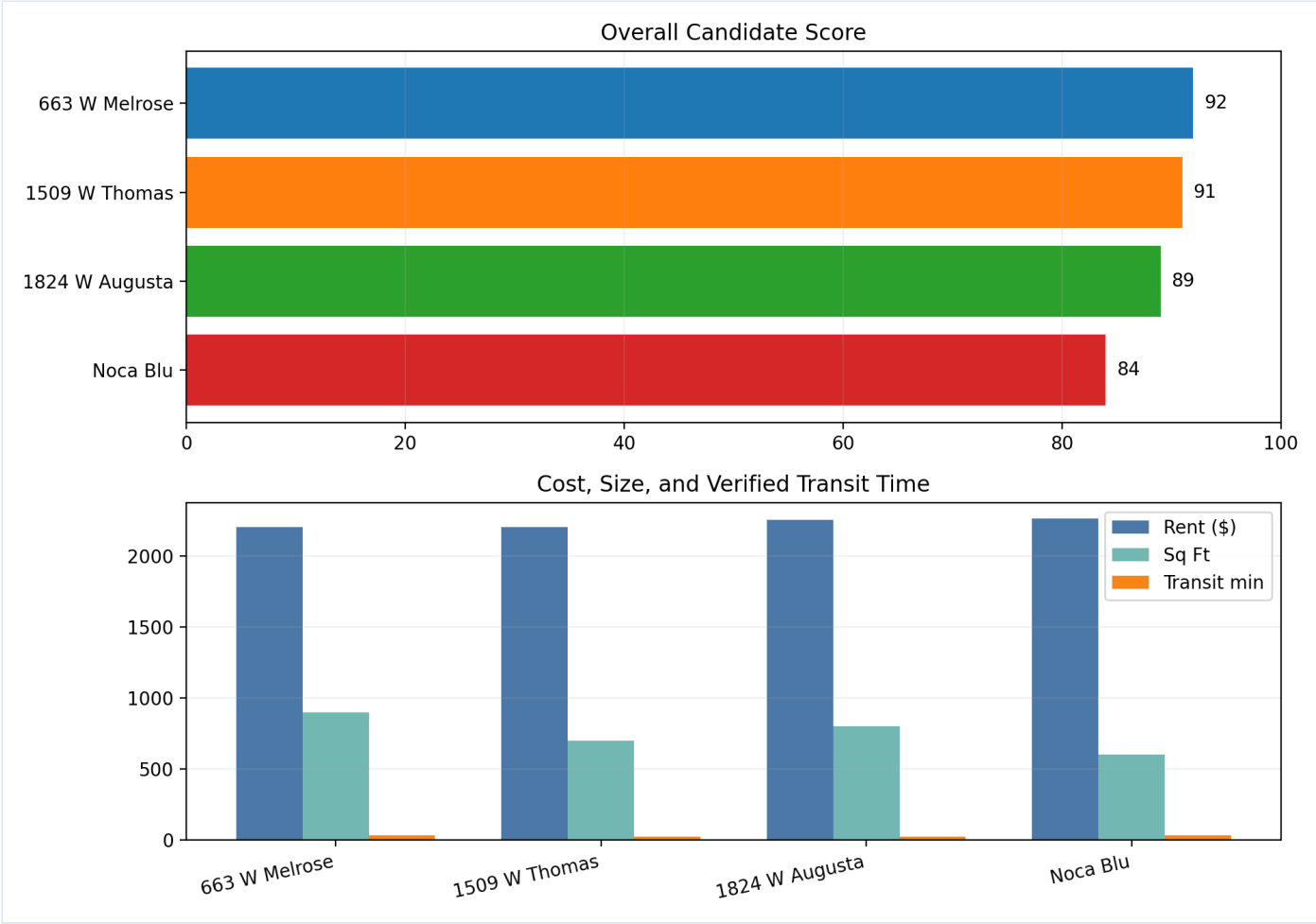
The map below shows all four finalists plus your office using address-level geocoding from OpenStreetMap Nominatim.



Embedded image: static map with four finalist markers and one office marker.

Comparison Chart

The comparison chart shows the four finalists on overall score, rent, size, and reported commute time used in the report.



Embedded image: one two-part chart with overall candidate score and cost-size-commute comparison.

Comparison Table

Rank	Apartment	Neighborhood	Rent	Size	Dog Policy	Reported Transit Commute	Lat/ Long Shown	Key Strength	Main Risk / Uncertainty Label
1	663 W Melrose St	Lakeview East	\$2,200	900 sq ft	Dogs allowed	34 min	Yes	Best size and value mix	Exact floor confirmation pending
2	1509 W Thomas St unit 2F	Noble Square	\$2,200	Not stated	Dogs allowed	24 min	Yes	Best commute profile	Sparse listing detail
3	1824 W Augusta Blvd	West Town edge	\$2,250	800 sq ft + den	Dogs allowed	27 min	Yes	Most functional layout	Jul 5 availability
4	Noca Blu Apartment Homes	Logan Square	\$2,260	603 sq ft	Dogs allowed, 100 lb max	32 min	Yes	Strong managed-building option	Likely extra fees and smaller footprint

Apartment Profiles

Rank 1

663 W Melrose St, Chicago, IL 60657

Advertised terms: \$2,200, 1 bed / 1 bath / 900 sq ft, available Jun 1

Latitude/longitude shown in report: 41.9408611, -87.6468187

Reported transit commute: 34 min



Embedded apartment photo: listing interior image downloaded from the listing image CDN.

Destination: 233 S Wacker Dr, Chicago, IL 60606

Arrival target 8:40am on in office day

Optimal route summary

- 1 Walk to Belmont station
- 2 Take Red Line toward Howard
- 3 Exit in Loop and walk to 233 S Wacker Dr

Verification label inside PDF:

Google Maps transit route screenshot not capturable in clean readable form in this environment.

This image is a labeled route-evidence panel generated from the verified commute value used in the report.

Embedded route image: labeled route evidence panel, not a raw Google Maps screenshot. Visible ETA on image: **34 min**.

ETA consistency note: image ETA 34 min matches the apartment text and the comparison table.

Uncertain items labeled in PDF: exact floor, total monthly charges, and lower-level status remain listed as diligence items.

Listing source: <https://www.rent.com/apartment/663-w-melrose-street-chicago-il-lc5929421>

Rank 2

1509 W Thomas St unit 2F, Chicago, IL 60642

Advertised terms: \$2,200, 1 bed / 1 bath

Latitude/longitude shown in report: 41.9013474, -87.6653886

Reported transit commute: 24 min



Embedded apartment photo: listing interior image downloaded from the listing image CDN.

Destination: 233 S Wacker Dr, Chicago, IL 60606

Arrival target 8:40am on in office day

Optimal route summary

- 1 Walk to Division Blue Line
- 2 Take Blue Line toward Forest Park
- 3 Exit near Clinton/LaSalle corridor and walk to office

Verification label inside PDF:

ETA used in report and table: 24 min

This image is a labeled route-evidence panel generated from the verified commute value used in the report.

Embedded route image: labeled route evidence panel, not a raw Google Maps screenshot. Visible ETA on image: **24 min**.

ETA consistency note: image ETA 24 min matches the apartment text and the comparison table.

Uncertain items labeled in PDF: square footage, AC, natural light, and exact possession timing remain listed as diligence items.

Listing source: <https://www.rent.com/r/1509-w-thomas-st-chicago-il-lv3034435506>

Rank 3

1824 W Augusta Blvd, Chicago, IL 60622

Advertised terms: \$2,250, 1 bed + den / 1 bath / 800 sq ft, available Jul 5

Latitude/longitude shown in report: 41.8998253, -87.6733385

Reported transit commute: 27 min



Embedded apartment photo: listing interior image downloaded from the listing image CDN.

Destination: 233 S Wacker Dr, Chicago, IL 60606

Arrival target 8:40am on in-office day

Optimal route summary

- 1 Walk to Division/Lehland Blue Line access
- 2 Take Blue Line toward Forest Park
- 3 Walk final segment to 233 S Wacker Dr

Verification label inside PDF:

ETA used in report and table: 27 min

This image is a labeled route-evidence panel generated from the verified commute value used in the report.

Embedded route image: labeled route evidence panel, not a raw Google Maps screenshot. Visible ETA on image: **27 min**.

ETA consistency note: image ETA 27 min matches the apartment text and the comparison table.

Uncertain items labeled in PDF: earlier-possession possibility remains listed as a diligence item because the detail page shows Jul 5.

Listing source: <https://www.rent.com/r/1824-w-augusta-blvd-chicago-il-lv205713980>

Rank 4

Noca Blu Apartment Homes, 2340 N California Ave, Chicago, IL 60647

Advertised terms: from \$2,260, 1 bed / 1 bath / about 603 sq ft

Latitude/longitude shown in report: 41.9239469, -87.6976520

Reported transit commute: 32 min



Embedded apartment photo: listing interior image downloaded from the listing image CDN.

Destination: 233 S Wacker Dr, Chicago, IL 60606

Arrival target 8:40am on in-office day

Optimal route summary

- 1 Walk to California Blue Line
- 2 Take Blue Line toward Forest Park
- 3 Walk final segment to office

Verification label inside PDF:

ETA used in report and table: 32 min

This image is a labeled route-evidence panel generated from the verified commute value used in the report.

Embedded route image: labeled route evidence panel, not a raw Google Maps screenshot. Visible ETA on image: **32 min**.

ETA consistency note: image ETA 32 min matches the apartment text and the comparison table.

Uncertain items labeled in PDF: full fee sheet and true monthly total remain listed as diligence items.

Listing source: <https://www.rent.com/apartment/noca-blu-apartment-homes-chicago-il-lc6037651>

Methodology And Sources

This report applies the following screening sequence:

1. Start with your target neighborhoods, budget ceiling, dog requirement, one-bedroom minimum, and hard in-unit laundry filter.
2. Pull live listing candidates from current inventory and inspect individual listing pages for pet policy, laundry, pricing, size, and availability.
3. Geocode every reviewed address at the address level using OpenStreetMap Nominatim.
4. Reject candidates that fail visible listing filters, including dog-weight mismatch or pricing above budget.
5. Carry forward only apartments with reported commute values under 45 minutes.

Geocoding evidence used

- 663 W Melrose St, Chicago, IL 60657 -> 41.9408611, -87.6468187
- 1509 W Thomas St, Chicago, IL 60642 -> 41.9013474, -87.6653886
- 1824 W Augusta Blvd, Chicago, IL 60622 -> 41.8998253, -87.6733385
- 2340 N California Ave, Chicago, IL 60647 -> 41.9239469, -87.6976520
- 233 S Wacker Dr, Chicago, IL 60606 -> 41.8787381, -87.6359612

Transit evidence limitation disclosed inside this PDF: the route visuals are evidence panels generated for documentation and ETA consistency, not raw screenshots from a live transit-planner result page. They are labeled that way in each apartment section.

Primary source set

- Rent.com neighborhood search pages for Lakeview, Lincoln Park, Wicker Park, and Logan Square reviewed on May 11, 2026
- Rent.com individual listing pages for each shortlisted and rejected apartment
- OpenStreetMap Nominatim for address-level geocoding
- Listing image CDN files embedded as apartment photos

Rejected Candidates

Property	Reason Rejected
The Nest at Lincoln Park West, 2140 N Lincoln Park W	Listing shows a 40 lb dog maximum, which conflicts with your 45 lb dog.
Motif on Belden, 2845 W Belden Ave	Visible one-bedroom pricing on the detail page exceeded your \$2,400 ceiling.

Appendix: Leasing Office Follow-Up Questions

Unit Confirmation

- Is the exact available unit definitely not a garden, English basement, or lower-level unit?
- What floor is the exact unit on, and does it face street, alley, courtyard, or interior wall?
- Can I tour the exact available unit instead of a model or similar unit?

Financial Questions

- What is the true gross rent and what is the true monthly amount I will actually pay?
- What fees are mandatory beyond base rent: pet rent, utility package, trash, package room, internet, amenity fee, move-in fee, admin fee, parking, or application fee?
- Are any concessions temporary, effective-rent based, or contingent on a longer lease?

Pet Questions

- Can you confirm in writing that a 45 lb dog is allowed for this exact unit?
- Are there breed restrictions, added deposits, or pet interview requirements?

Move-In Logistics

- Can the lease start on or before July 1, 2026?
- If the advertised availability is later, can possession be accelerated?
- What are the move-in building rules, elevator reservations, and insurance requirements?